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“We work mainly on Windows NT and 2000 operating systems. We plan to shift to Windows 2000 completely, but not as of now. We have around 100 people in the organisation and only about 25 per cent of them use computers. We use MS Outlook and MS Office, and most of our work is done on word processors. We use McAfee Antivirus that is updated daily. If we are to upgrade the OS, it would be based on our requirements. We will look at the best software for upgrading. If the business demands it, it will be done, otherwise we simply cannot splurge, as upgradation involves additional expenditure for training, hardware and others—all incidental.”



WHEN WILL

Businesses, more often than not, take a long time to switch over to newer versions of software. Five industry experts tell us why they don't upgrade fast



Amay Choudhary
Corporate IT Manager

“We work on the Microsoft platform. The OS comprise Windows 95, 98 and XP. We use McAfee Antivirus that is periodically updated. While it is not possible for all systems in the office to be updated regularly, all are at par within a month's time. Our office work is spread across 70 locations with nearly 300 machines on the network. Maintenance is mostly done in-house and only maintenance for hardware is outsourced. Our MS Office usage is largely restricted to MS Word and MS Excel. Only if there is an absolute need for our business, will we upgrade the software. At present, the work doesn't demand it. Besides, when we upgrade our software, we will invariably have to upgrade 40 per cent of our existing hardware as it will not support the new software.

“We have introduced Citrix for remote computing and management to save costs. We may not upgrade every system in the office, as some software that works best on 98 may not do so on XP. The decision to upgrade will depend on various factors. More importantly, will there be an increase in productivity after upgradation? If the reports promise an upswing in productivity then it makes sense to upgrade. There must be logic to support the change.”